

Olympiad Test Paper — Sanskrit (Class 7)

Chapter 10: दशमः कः? (Dashamah Kah? - Who Is the Tenth?)

Subject	Sanskrit (NCERT Class 7, Deepakam)
Chapter	10 — दशमः कः? (Dashamah Kah? - Who Is the Tenth?)
Total Questions	60 (Multiple Choice, single correct)
Maximum Marks	240
Suggested Time	90 minutes

Marking scheme: +4 for each correct answer · -1 for each wrong answer · 0 if unattempted.

Instructions: Each question has four options (A), (B), (C), (D); exactly one is correct. Questions test the Tenth-Man parable and its grammar. Watch the classic traps: the 'missing tenth' is the COUNTER himself - each boy forgot to count himself (Vedanta's तत्त्वमसि); only the outside पथिकः counts correctly; तीर्त्वा is a GERUND ('having crossed') and अगणयत् the IMPERFECT PAST ('he counted', root गण् 'count', not गा 'sing'); and कतमः asks 'which of MANY?' while कतरः asks 'which of TWO?'. Distinguish cardinals (दश 'ten') from ordinals (दशमः 'tenth'). Sanskrit in Devanagari. Do not write on this paper — mark answers on your answer sheet.

1. In the parable, how many boys cross the river?

- (A) nine (B) seven
(C) ten (D) twelve

2. दशमः कः? means:

- (A) Where is the river? (B) How many boys?
(C) Who is the leader? (D) Who is the tenth?

3. What do the ten boys do at the start of the story?

- (A) cross a river (by swimming) (B) climb a mountain
(C) build a house (D) light a fire

4. नदीं तीर्त्वा पारं गताः means:

- (A) having crossed the river, they went to the other bank
(B) they built a river (C) they drank the river
(D) they sang by the river

5. After crossing, each boy wants to make sure that:

- (A) the river is deep (B) the bank is far
(C) the sun has set (D) all ten are safe (none drowned)

6. The whole parable depends on the number of boys being:
(A) any number (B) unknown
(C) always changing (D) ten
7. When each boy counts, he counts only:
(A) nine (नव) (B) ten
(C) eight (D) eleven
8. Each boy counts only nine because he:
(A) forgets to count himself (B) cannot count past nine
(C) loses one boy in the river (D) counts too fast
9. Counting nine, each boy wrongly concludes that:
(A) all are safe (B) the tenth has drowned
(C) there were only nine (D) one boy ran away
10. मग्नः, the word for the supposedly lost boy, means:
(A) lost in a forest (B) submerged / drowned
(C) asleep (D) hidden
11. The boys' mistake is that the 'missing tenth' is actually:
(A) really drowned (B) an eleventh boy
(C) the traveler
(D) the counter himself (each forgot to count himself)
12. Each boy in turn miscounts, so the error is:
(A) made by only one boy (B) a problem with the river
(C) shared by all of them, each forgetting himself
(D) caused by the traveler
13. Who finally counts the boys correctly?
(A) the पथिकः (the passing traveler) (B) the youngest boy
(C) the leader alone (D) no one
14. The traveler reveals the truth by saying:
(A) दशमः मग्नः ('the tenth drowned') (B) नव बालकाः ('nine boys')
(C) दशमः त्वम् असि ('you are the tenth') (D) नदी गभीरा ('the river is deep')
15. दशमः त्वम् असि means:
(A) you are the tenth (B) the tenth is lost
(C) I am the tenth (D) there is no tenth
16. The 'tenth' the boys were searching for turns out to be:
(A) an outsider (B) the leader / counter himself
(C) the traveler (D) truly drowned

17. Only the outside viewer (the पथिकः) counts correctly because he:
 (A) can count higher than nine (B) is himself the tenth boy
 (C) saved a drowning boy
 (D) is not caught up in the boys' own mistake and counts all of them
18. The boys were 'blinded' because they:
 (A) could not see the river (B) were asleep
 (C) trusted their own count without checking it from outside
 (D) never counted at all
19. In the Vedantic reading, 'you are the tenth' points to:
 (A) a real drowning (B) a tenth river
 (C) the Self that was missing all along (D) an eleventh boy
20. The parable is linked to the Vedantic teaching:
 (A) वन्दे मातरम् (B) सेवा परमो धर्मः
 (C) तत्त्वमसि ('you are That') (D) अन्नाद् भवन्ति भूतानि
21. The deeper point of the story is that:
 (A) rivers are dangerous (B) counting is useless
 (C) ten is an unlucky number
 (D) what we search for (the Self) is the very one searching
22. Reading दशमः त्वम् असि as only a queue-position misses:
 (A) the number of boys (B) the name of the river
 (C) the time of day
 (D) its metaphysical meaning (the Self is what was missing)
23. The 'lost tenth' was never truly lost because:
 (A) he swam away
 (B) he was present all along - the one doing the counting
 (C) he was the traveler (D) he was an eleventh boy
24. The Sanskrit ordinals प्रथमः, द्वितीयः, तृतीयः mean:
 (A) one, two, three (cardinals) (B) tenth, ninth, eighth
 (C) first, second, third (D) this, that, the other
25. दशमः means:
 (A) ten (the count) (B) second
 (C) tenth (D) ninth
26. Ordinal numbers (प्रथमः ... दशमः) tell us a thing's:
 (A) weight (B) colour
 (C) position in order (first, second, ...) (D) price

27. The ordinal for 'second' is:

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|------------|--------------|
| (A) प्रथमः | (B) द्वितीयः |
| (C) तृतीयः | (D) दशमः |

28. The difference between दश and दशमः is that दश is the _____ and दशमः is the _____.

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|--|--|
| (A) cardinal 'ten' ... ordinal 'tenth' | (B) ordinal 'tenth' ... cardinal 'ten' |
| (C) both mean 'ten' | (D) both mean 'tenth' |

29. If the boys had been counted in order, the leader would be the _____ they kept missing.

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|--------------------|-----------------------|
| (A) प्रथमः (first) | (B) द्वितीयः (second) |
| (C) नवमः (ninth) | (D) दशमः (tenth) |

30. तीर्त्वा means:

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|---------------------|---|
| (A) before crossing | (B) while crossing |
| (C) unable to cross | (D) having crossed / having swum across |

31. तीर्त्वा is a:

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|------------------------|--|
| (A) present-tense verb | (B) gerund (an indeclinable 'having done X') |
| (C) ordinal number | (D) noun |

32. In नदीं तीर्त्वा पारं गताः, the gerund तीर्त्वा marks the action that:

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|--|-------------------|
| (A) happens last | (B) never happens |
| (C) happens first (crossing), before they reach the bank | |
| (D) is in the future | |

33. A gerund like तीर्त्वा links two actions by showing one is:

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|---|-------------------|
| (A) done at the same instant only | |
| (B) completed before the next ('having crossed, they went') | |
| (C) never completed | (D) in the future |

34. अगणयत् means:

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|-------------------|-------------------|
| (A) he will count | (B) let him count |
| (C) he counted | (D) he sang |

35. The tense of अगणयत् is:

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|---------------------------------|--------------|
| (A) imperfect past (laN-lakara) | (B) present |
| (C) future | (D) optative |

36. अगणयत् comes from the root गण्, meaning:

- | | |
|-------------|--------------------------|
| (A) to sing | (B) to count / enumerate |
| (C) to swim | (D) to drown |

37. गण् ('to count') must not be confused with गा, which means:

- (A) to sing
(C) to cross

- (B) to count
(D) to drown

38. 'He counts' (present) and 'he counted' (past) of गण् are:

- (A) गणयति and अगणयत्
(B) गायति and अगायत्
(C) तरति and अतरत्
(D) जानाति and अजानात्

39. Listening for the consonant tells गण् (count) from गा (sing); गणयति means:

- (A) he sings
(B) he counts
(C) he swims
(D) he knows

40. कतमः means:

- (A) which (of two)?
(B) which (of many)?
(C) who?
(D) what?

41. कतरः means:

- (A) which (of two)?
(B) which (of many)?
(C) when?
(D) where?

42. The difference between कतमः and कतरः is:

- (A) कतमः asks 'which of two', कतरः 'which of many'
(B) they are identical
(C) both ask 'who'
(D) कतमः asks 'which of many', कतरः 'which of two'

43. To ask 'which one of the ten boys drowned?', the precise word is:

- (A) कतरः (which of two)
(B) कः (who, generally)
(C) किम् (what)
(D) कतमः (which of many)

44. If choosing between just two paths, the correct 'which?' is:

- (A) कतरः
(B) कतमः
(C) कति
(D) कदा

45. पथिकः means:

- (A) a proper name
(B) a wayfarer / traveler (a common noun, not a name)
(C) a river
(D) a number

46. Words like पथिकः, यायावरः and अध्वगः all mean:

- (A) a traveler / wanderer
(B) a counter
(C) a river
(D) a boy

47. In the parable, the पथिकः is:

- (A) the leader of the boys
(B) an anonymous wayfarer who acts as the teacher figure
(C) a named king
(D) the drowned boy

48. मनः means:

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|-------------------------|--------------|
| (A) delighted | (B) counting |
| (C) submerged / drowned | (D) crossing |

49. The boys feared that the tenth was मनः, that is:

- | | |
|---------------------------|--------------------------|
| (A) delighted on the bank | (B) drowned in the river |
| (C) singing a song | (D) counting the others |

50. विषण्णाः means:

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|---------------|--------------------|
| (A) delighted | (B) counting |
| (C) crossing | (D) sad / dejected |

51. प्रहृष्टाः means:

- | | |
|-----------|---------------------------|
| (A) sad | (B) drowned |
| (C) tired | (D) delighted / overjoyed |

52. The boys go from विषण्णाः to प्रहृष्टाः, that is, from:

- | | |
|----------------------|----------------------|
| (A) sad to delighted | (B) delighted to sad |
| (C) tired to rested | (D) wet to dry |

53. The boys' joy (हर्ष) on finding the tenth is distinct from आश्चर्य and विस्मय, which mean:

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|-------------------------|---------------------------|
| (A) sadness and fear | (B) joy and joy |
| (C) surprise and wonder | (D) counting and crossing |

54. Which word-meaning pair is CORRECT?

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|---------------------|----------------------|
| (A) पथिकः = a river | (B) अगणयत् = he sang |
| (C) मनः = drowned | (D) प्रहृष्टाः = sad |

55. Which grammar pair is CORRECT?

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|--|----------------------------------|
| (A) तीर्त्वा = present tense; अगणयत् = future | |
| (B) तीर्त्वा = gerund ('having crossed'); अगणयत् = imperfect past ('he counted') | |
| (C) अगणयत् = optative | (D) तीर्त्वा = an ordinal number |

56. Which interrogative pair is CORRECT?

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|---|---|
| (A) कतमः = which of two; कतरः = which of many | (B) both = who |
| (C) both = what | (D) कतमः = which of many; कतरः = which of two |

57. The central theme of this chapter is:

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| (A) the parable that the missing 'tenth' is the Self / the counter himself | |
| (B) a fox and grapes | (C) banking and finance |
| (D) the rise of empires | |

58. The chapter pairs the parable with grammar lessons on:

- | | |
|---|---------------------------|
| (A) only the dative case | (B) direction words (-तः) |
| (C) ordinals, the gerund (तीर्त्वा), the imperfect past (अगणयत्) and कतमः | |

(D) the six tastes

59. Putting it together, 'दशमः त्वम् असि' teaches that:

(A) the tenth truly drowned

(B) there were really nine boys

(C) the traveler was the tenth

(D) the tenth was never lost - each boy forgot to count himself, and the Self was present all along

60. A student claims: 'अगणयत् means he will count, and कतमः asks which of two.' The best correction is:

(A) the student is fully correct

(B) अगणयत् is past ('he counted'), and कतमः asks 'which of many' (कतरः is 'which of two')

(C) अगणयत् is past, and कतमः asks which of two

(D) अगणयत् is future, and कतमः asks which of many

Solutions — Sanskrit (Class 7), Chapter 10: दशमः कः? (Dashamah Kah? - Who Is the Tenth?)

Marking: +4 correct, –1 wrong, 0 unattempted. Maximum marks **240**.

Answer Key

Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans
1	C	11	D	21	D	31	B	41	A	51	D
2	D	12	C	22	D	32	C	42	D	52	A
3	A	13	A	23	B	33	B	43	D	53	C
4	A	14	C	24	C	34	C	44	A	54	C
5	D	15	A	25	C	35	A	45	B	55	B
6	D	16	B	26	C	36	B	46	A	56	D
7	A	17	D	27	B	37	A	47	B	57	A
8	A	18	C	28	A	38	A	48	C	58	C
9	B	19	C	29	D	39	B	49	B	59	D
10	B	20	C	30	D	40	B	50	D	60	B

Answer-key distribution: A = 15, B = 15, C = 15, D = 15.

Worked Solutions

- (C)** Ten boys (दश बालकाः) cross the river. The whole parable depends on the number being ten, not nine, seven, or twelve.
- (D)** दशमः कः? means 'Who is the tenth?'. It does not ask where the river is, how many boys, or who the leader is.
- (A)** The boys cross a river by swimming. They do not climb a mountain, build a house, or light a fire.
- (A)** It means 'having crossed the river, they went to the other bank'. The other readings are wrong.
- (D)** Each boy wants to be sure all ten are safe. The depth of the river, distance of the bank, and time of day are not the concern.
- (D)** The parable depends on there being exactly ten boys. Not any number, an unknown, or a changing one.

7. (A) Each boy counts only nine (नव). Not ten, eight, or eleven.

8. (A) Each counts nine because he forgets to count himself. It is not an inability to count, a lost boy, or counting too fast.

9. (B) Counting nine, each wrongly concludes the tenth drowned. The truth is all are safe; there were ten, and none ran away.

10. (B) मग्नः means 'submerged / drowned'. It does not mean lost in a forest, asleep, or hidden.

11. (D) The 'missing tenth' is the counter himself, whom each boy forgot to count. He is not really drowned, an eleventh boy, or the traveler.

12. (C) The error is shared by all - each forgets himself. It is not one boy's, the river's, or the traveler's fault.

13. (A) The passing पथिकः counts correctly. Not the youngest boy, the leader alone, or no one.

14. (C) He says 'दशमः त्वम् असि' ('you are the tenth'). The other lines are not his revelation.

15. (A) दशमः त्वम् असि means 'you are the tenth'. It does not say the tenth is lost, that 'I' am the tenth, or that there is no tenth.

16. (B) The 'tenth' is the leader / counter himself. He is not an outsider, the traveler, or truly drowned.

17. (D) The outside viewer counts all of them, free of the boys' self-forgetting error. It is not about counting higher, being the tenth, or a rescue.

18. (C) They trusted their own count without an outside check. They could see the river, were awake, and did count (wrongly).

19. (C) Vedantically, 'you are the tenth' points to the Self that was missing all along. Not a real drowning, a river, or an eleventh boy.

20. (C) It illustrates तत्त्वमसि ('you are That'). The others are from different chapters and themes.

21. (D) The deeper point is that the Self we search for is the very one searching. It is not about dangerous rivers, useless counting, or unlucky numbers.

22. (D) A mere queue-position reading misses the metaphysical meaning (the Self is what was missing). Not the boy-count, river-name, or time.

- 23. (B)** He was present all along as the counter. He did not swim away, was not the traveler, and was not an eleventh boy.
- 24. (C)** प्रथमः, द्वितीयः, तृतीयः are the ordinals 'first, second, third'. They are not cardinals, the high ordinals, or demonstratives.
- 25. (C)** दशमः is the ordinal 'tenth'. The cardinal 'ten' is दश; 'second' is द्वितीयः and 'ninth' नवमः.
- 26. (C)** Ordinals tell position in order. They do not tell weight, colour, or price.
- 27. (B)** 'Second' is द्वितीयः. प्रथमः is first, तृतीयः third, and दशमः tenth.
- 28. (A)** दश is the cardinal 'ten'; दशमः the ordinal 'tenth'. The reversal and 'both same' options are wrong.
- 29. (D)** The leader is the दशमः (tenth) they kept missing. Not the first, second, or ninth.
- 30. (D)** तीर्त्वा means 'having crossed / swum across'. It does not mean before crossing, while crossing, or unable to cross.
- 31. (B)** तीर्त्वा is a gerund ('having done X'). It is not a present-tense verb, an ordinal, or a noun.
- 32. (C)** The gerund marks the crossing as happening first, before reaching the bank. It is not last, non-occurring, or future.
- 33. (B)** A gerund shows one action completed before the next. Not simultaneous-only, never completed, or future.
- 34. (C)** अगणयत् means 'he counted' (past). Not 'will count', 'let him count', or 'he sang'.
- 35. (A)** अगणयत् is the imperfect past (लङ्-लकार). It is not present, future, or optative.
- 36. (B)** अगणयत् comes from गण् ('to count'). गा is 'to sing'; swimming and drowning are other roots.
- 37. (A)** गा means 'to sing', distinct from गण् ('to count'). It does not mean count, cross, or drown.
- 38. (A)** गण् gives गणयति (present) and अगणयत् (past). गायति/अगायत् is from गा (sing); तरति/अतरत् from तृ (cross); जानाति/अजानात् from ज्ञा (know).
- 39. (B)** गणयति means 'he counts'. 'He sings' is गायति, 'he swims' तरति, and 'he knows' जानाति.
- 40. (B)** कतमः asks 'which of many?'. 'Which of two?' is कतरः, 'who?' कः, and 'what?' किम्.
- 41. (A)** कतरः asks 'which of two?'. 'Which of many?' is कतमः, 'when?' कदा, and 'where?' कुत्र.

42. (D) कतमः asks 'which of many' and कतरः 'which of two'. The reversal, 'identical', and 'both who' options are wrong.

43. (D) Choosing among ten uses कतमः (which of many). कतरः is for two, कः is general 'who', and किम् is 'what'.

44. (A) For two options the correct word is कतरः. कतमः is for many, कति is 'how many', and कदा is 'when'.

45. (B) पथिकः is a common noun, 'a wayfarer / traveler'. It is not a proper name, a river, or a number.

46. (A) पथिकः, यायावरः and अध्वगः all mean a traveler / wanderer. Not a counter, a river, or a boy.

47. (B) The पथिकः is an anonymous wayfarer acting as the teacher figure. He is not the leader, a named king, or a drowned boy.

48. (C) मग्नः means 'submerged / drowned'. It does not mean delighted, counting, or crossing.

49. (B) They feared the tenth was मग्नः (drowned in the river). Not delighted, singing, or counting.

50. (D) विषण्णाः means 'sad / dejected'. It does not mean delighted, counting, or crossing.

51. (D) प्रहृष्टाः means 'delighted / overjoyed' (from हृष्). It does not mean sad, drowned, or tired.

52. (A) They go from विषण्णाः (sad) to प्रहृष्टाः (delighted). Not the reverse, tired-to-rested, or wet-to-dry.

53. (C) आश्चर्य and विस्मय mean surprise and wonder, distinct from हर्ष (joy). They are not sadness/fear, joy, or counting/crossing.

54. (C) मग्नः = drowned. पथिकः is a traveler (not a river), अगणयत् is 'he counted' (not 'he sang'), and प्रहृष्टाः is delighted (not sad).

55. (B) तीर्त्वा is a gerund and अगणयत् the imperfect past. The other options misname the forms.

56. (D) कतमः = which of many and कतरः = which of two. The reversal and 'both who/what' options are wrong.

57. (A) The theme is the Tenth-Man parable: the missing 'tenth' is the Self / the counter himself. Not the fox fable, banking, or empires.

58. (C) It pairs the parable with ordinals, the gerund, the imperfect past and कतमः. Not only the dative, direction words, or tastes.

59. (D) It teaches that the tenth was never lost - each forgot to count himself, and the Self was present all along. The other readings are wrong.

60. (B) अगणयत् is past ('he counted'), and कतमः asks 'which of many' (कतरः is 'which of two'). The other options keep one or both errors.